



Information for the Acne Expert: Birth Control and the Impact on Acne

This document is not meant to be given to your client. Always advise your client to speak with their doctor about the birth control method that is best for them. Let your client know they should review the benefits and risks of any birth control they use.

Birth control pills are popular forms of contraception. Typically, these forms of birth control are divided up as estrogen dominant or progestin dominant and have varying degrees of androgenic (testosterone like) effects. Birth control methods that are estrogen dominant are less often associated with exacerbating acne, while those that are progestin dominant are more often associated with exacerbating acne.

QUICK REFERENCE CHART

COMMON PROGESTINS IN BIRTH CONTROL	PROGESTIN DOMINANT	ESTROGEN DOMINANT
Norethindrone		X (if paired with at least 35 mcg of EE*)
Norethindrone Acetate		X (if paired with at least 35 mcg of EE*)
Ethinodiol Diacetate		X (if paired with at least 35 mcg of EE*)
Levonorgestrel	X	
Norgestrel	X	
Desogestrel		X (if paired with at least 35 mcg of EE*)
Norgestimate		X (if paired with at least 35 mcg of EE*)
Drospirenone		X (even if paired with < 35 mcg of EE*)

*EE is Ethinyl Estradiol